

Q1: A truly participatory democracy is built upon the pillars of inclusivity and shared human values, with technology serving as a tool, not a solution. Elaborate (10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about participatory democracy.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting importance of inclusivity and Human values in participatory democracy.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: Participatory democracy is a model of democracy that emphasizes the direct involvement of citizens in the decision-making processes. In a participatory democracy, inclusivity and human values are fundamental.

Inclusivity and Human Values:

- **Ensuring Representation:** Inclusivity ensures all social groups have a voice in democratic processes.
 - For example, reservation policies in India aim to include marginalized communities in decision-making.
- **Encouraging Participation:** Inclusivity encourages active citizen engagement.
 - Initiatives like community forums and public consultations invite diverse viewpoints, enhancing democratic decision-making.
- **Building Trust:** Human values such as empathy and respect build trust between citizens and institutions.
 - For example, participatory budgeting projects often lead to increased public trust in local government.

Technology can aid the process, but it is not sufficient alone. Effective participation relies on more than just technological tools.

Technology's Role in ensuring participatory democracy:

- **Facilitating Access:** Technology can make democratic processes more accessible. For example, CPGRAM, e-RTI, MyGov, etc.
- **Enhancing Communication:** Digital tools can improve communication between citizens and governments such as social media campaigns and raise awareness on important issues.
- **Transparent Governance:** Digital tools promote transparency by making government data and decision-making processes accessible to the public.

Limitations of Technology:

- **Digital Divide:** Technology alone cannot address disparities. In India, rural areas often lack reliable internet, which limits their participation in digital democracy.
- **Privacy Concerns:** Over-reliance on technology can lead to privacy issues. The misuse of data from social media platforms can undermine democratic processes and individual freedoms.

While technology enhances democratic participation, inclusivity and human values are crucial for a truly participatory democracy. Both elements together ensure a more equitable and effective democratic system.

Q2: Analyse the challenges faced by Self Help Groups (SHGs) in effectively functioning as agents of socio-economic change. Suggest measures to strengthen their capacity and sustainability.

(10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Self-Help Group (SHG).

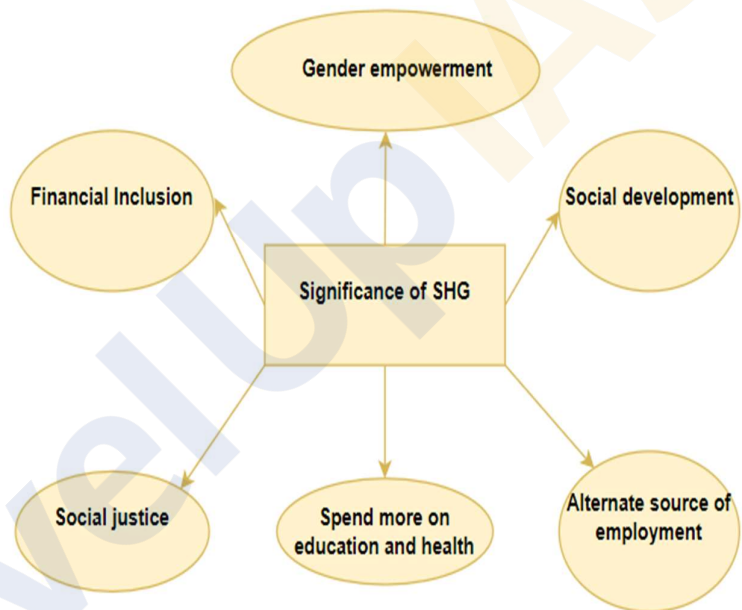
Body: Address the demand by highlighting key challenges with Self-Help Group (SHG) followed by way forward.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: A Self-Help Group (SHG) is a voluntary association of individuals, typically from similar socio-economic backgrounds, who come together to address common issues, improve their economic status, and empower themselves socially and economically.

Challenges with Self Help Groups (SHGs):

- **Patriarchal Mindset:** Cultural norms and social stigmas discourage women's participation in SHGs. In states where patriarchy is deeply ingrained, women's financial and social roles are restricted.
- **Lack of Institutional Banking Facilities:** As per Radhakrishnan Committee on Credit-Related Issues in SHGs about 48% of SHG members had to borrow from local money lenders, relatives, and neighbors.
- **Poor Infrastructure:** Many SHGs are situated in rural and remote areas lacking connectivity via roads or railways, adversely affecting access to larger marketplaces.
- **Predominance in Agricultural Activities:** Many SHG activities depend on primitive skills with low value addition per worker, particularly in the primary sector.



Way Forward

- **High productivity areas:** SHGs in rural areas should be introduced to non-agricultural businesses and provided with state-of-the-art machinery.
- **Financial Assistance:** Priority sector lending and subsidized schemes can provide crucial financial support to SHGs, helping them thrive.
- **Integrated Approach:** Develop an integrated approach that connects SHGs with both backward linkages (technology) and forward linkages (processing and marketing organizations).
- **Skill Development:** Focus on skill development to enable SHG members to participate in higher value-added products and services.
- **SHG Monitoring Cell:** Establish a separate SHG monitoring cell to collect both quantitative and qualitative data for better oversight and improvement.

SHGs are a powerful tool for economic and social empowerment, particularly in rural areas. They foster self-reliance, improve financial inclusion, and contribute to the overall development of communities.

Q3: Evaluate the challenges faced by social audit mechanisms in effectively monitoring government programs. Also, recommend remedies to overcome these challenges. (10 Marks, 150 words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about social audit.

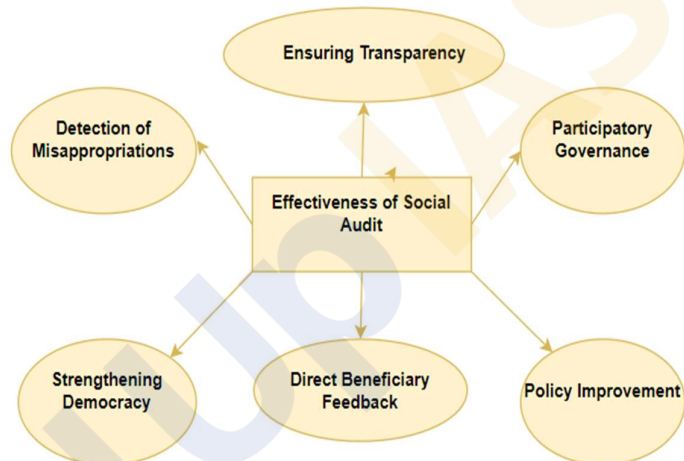
Body: Address the demand by highlighting challenges Faced by Social Audit Mechanisms followed by way forward.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic.

Answer: A social audit is a process in which government's activities and performance are evaluated from a social responsibility perspective, with active involvement from the community and stakeholders.

Challenges Faced by Social Audit Mechanisms:

- **Limited Awareness and Understanding:** Communities and local administrative bodies often lack awareness of social audits, hindering participation and effectiveness.
 - For example, many residents in remote villages of Chhattisgarh are unaware of the MGNREGA social audit process.
- **Resistance from Authorities:** Authorities may see social audits as a threat, leading to resistance.
- **Data Manipulation:** Records are sometimes manipulated to show better outcomes, undermining the credibility of social audits.
- **Temporal Limitations:** Short-term audits may not capture long-term benefits of schemes.
 - For example, afforestation project audits in Jharkhand may not immediately show ecological and economic benefits.
- **Inadequate Follow-up Mechanisms:** Weak follow-up mechanisms can result in inaction.
 - For example, irregularities in Tamil Nadu's mid-day meal scheme saw delayed rectifications due to poor redressal systems.



Way Forward:

- **Community Participation:** Ensure inclusive involvement of all community members, such as Kerala's "Kudumbashree" initiative involving women in social audits.
- **Transparent Processes:** Display all audit data publicly, like Andhra Pradesh's MGNREGA model with transparent wage and material cost listings.
- **Capacity Building:** Conduct regular training for auditors, exemplified by Rajasthan's MKSS training programs.
- **Digital Integration:** Use apps for real-time data collection, as seen in Telangana's social audit process.
- **Feedback Mechanisms:** Organize post-audit meetings to gather feedback, demonstrated in Maharashtra.

Social audits, as a tool for ensuring **transparency** and **accountability** in the **democratic setup** of India, have the potential to bring about **transformative changes** in the way public schemes are implemented. With the right best practices, India can harness the full potential of **social audits**, ensuring that the benefits of schemes reach the grassroots levels.

Additional Information:

- **Collaboration with Civil Society:** Partner with NGOs for expertise, as in Himachal Pradesh's audits on forest rights.
- **Prompt Redressal Systems:** Set up dedicated helplines for grievance redressal, like Odisha post-social

audits.

- **Periodic Reviews:** Conduct yearly audits to incorporate lessons learned, such as Assam's public health system reviews.
- **Public Awareness Campaigns:** Use media campaigns to increase community involvement, like Bihar's radio and TV efforts on social audits.
- **Incorporating Diverse Tools:** Employ various tools like surveys and public hearings for comprehensive audits, exemplified by Gujarat's tribal welfare scheme audits.

Q4: Highlight the features of Mission Karmayogi and discuss its significance in transforming India's civil services. (10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Mission Karmayogi.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting key Features of Mission Karmayogi followed by significance of Mission Karmayogi in transforming India's Civil Services.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: Mission Karmayogi is the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building (NPCSCB) which aims to transform India's civil services. It focuses on equipping civil servants with the necessary mindset, skills, and knowledge to align with the vision of New India.

Key Features of Mission Karmayogi:

- **Unified Learning Platform:** Introduces the Integrated Government Online Training Platform (iGOT) for standardized training modules across departments.
- **Role-based Management:** Aligns work allocation, evaluation, promotion, and postings with individual competencies.
- **Behavioural Emphasis:** Focuses on fostering service-oriented behaviour and empathy alongside technical skills.
- **70:20:10 Learning Model:** Promotes on-the-job learning, peer-to-peer interaction, and formal training.
- **Feedback-driven Improvement:** Incorporates real-time feedback to refine and enhance training effectiveness.

Significance of Mission Karmayogi in transforming India's Civil Services:

- **Comprehensive Training:** Focuses on domain, functional, and behavioural competencies for holistic development.
- **Harmonized Training Standards:** Establishes uniform training standards nationwide to align with India's development goals.
- **Vision for New India:** Aims to cultivate a future-ready civil service aligned with New India's vision.
- **On-site Learning:** Emphasizes on-site learning alongside off-site training methods.
- **Adoption of Best Practices:** Collaborates with top learning content creators to ensure high-quality training resources.
- **Continuous Learning:** Enables civil servants to enhance competencies through self-directed and mandated learning paths.

Mission Karmayogi marks a significant step towards shaping a civil service that is skilled, responsive, and in tune with the goals of New India.

Additional Information:

Features of Mission Karmayogi:

- **Flexibility and Personalization:** Allows officers to choose courses aligned with their interests and professional needs.
- **Digital Learning:** Utilizes e-learning to provide flexible access to resources anytime, anywhere.

- Collaborative Environment: Encourages knowledge sharing and teamwork across ministries, departments, and regions.
- Global Best Practices: Integrates international standards to prepare civil servants for global challenges.
- Continuous Capacity Building: Emphasizes ongoing development to keep civil servants updated and relevant throughout their careers.
- Competency-driven Approach: Tailors training to specific job roles and competencies for effective performance.

Q5: What is Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI)? Discuss how it provides a comprehensive understanding of poverty at the individual level compared to traditional income-based measures. (10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about MPI and income-based approach difference.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting concept of MPI and How MPI helps in comprehensive understanding of poverty.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: Income alone often misses hidden poverty aspects such as poor health or inadequate education whereas Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) is a comprehensively assesses poverty at the individual level across multiple dimensions.

As per MPI, 271 million people were lifted out of multi-dimensional poverty between 2005-06 and 2016-17.

Concept of MPI

- **Three Dimensions of MPI:** MPI measures poverty using three dimensions: health, education, and standard of living.
 - For example: A household lacking in nutrition, sanitation, and electricity is considered multidimensionally poor.
- **Ten Indicators:** The dimensions are further broken down into ten indicators including child mortality, nutrition, years of schooling, school attendance, cooking fuel, sanitation, drinking water, electricity, housing, and assets.

How MPI helps in comprehensive understanding of poverty:

- **Individual-Level Assessment:** MPI looks at poverty at an individual level.
 - for example, MPI shows that a child in a poor family might be deprived of education and nutrition.
- **Multidimensional Approach:** MPI considers multiple deprivations, offering a broader perspective on poverty.
 - For example: A person earning above the poverty line but lacking in health and education is still considered poor by MPI.
- **Severity of Poverty:** It determines the severity of poverty for example, a person deprived in six out of ten indicators faces severe multidimensional poverty.
- **Regional and Group Comparisons:** MPI reveals regional and group-specific deprivation, informing targeted interventions.
 - For example: In India, tribal areas might show high multidimensional poverty, necessitating focused development programs.

The Multidimensional Poverty Index offers a detailed understanding of poverty, enabling effective targeting of resources for a better outcome.

Q6: Discuss the role of a welfare state in eliminating systemic discrimination against women. What comprehensive measures should be implemented to ensure true gender equality and women empowerment? (10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about welfare state.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting role of a welfare state in eliminating systemic discrimination against women followed by comprehensive measures for ensuring true gender equality and women empowerment.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: A welfare state is fundamentally responsible for fostering equality and justice within its society. It plays a crucial role by adopting and implementing measures to address the deep-rooted socio-economic, educational, and political disadvantages faced by women.

Role of a Welfare State in Eliminating Systemic Discrimination Against Women:

- **Right to Equality:** Article 14 mandates the state to ensure the Right to Equality, thereby promoting gender equality and Article 15(3) of the Indian Constitution empowers the State to adopt measures of positive discrimination in favor of women.
- **Human Dignity:** The state must ensure women are treated with dignity and equality, free from biases.
- **Justice and Fairness:** The state must correct social injustices and ensure equal opportunities and rights for women.
 - According to the India Discrimination Report 2022, systemic discrimination causes significant employment inequality for women in India.
- **Women Empowerment:** By eliminating discrimination, the state enables women to exercise their autonomy and make choices without facing unjust barriers.
 - For example: women soldiers being allowed combat roles.
- **International Commitments:** India ratified the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW) requires it to enact non-discriminatory laws and policies.

Comprehensive Measures for Ensuring True Gender Equality and Women Empowerment:

- **Political Representation:** Implement the 106th Constitutional Amendment Act to increase women's representation in legislative bodies.
- **Economic Empowerment:** Provide skilling and micro-financing opportunities for financial independence.
 - For example, the Kudumbashree scheme in Kerala has financially empowered over a million women.
- **Education & Awareness:** Promote gender-sensitive education and awareness campaigns to challenge stereotypes.
 - For example, the "Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao" campaign promotes girls' education and raises awareness about gender biases.
- **Progressive Legislation:** Enact laws and policies to prevent workplace discrimination.
 - For example, the Maternity Benefit Act, 2017, provides 26 weeks of paid maternity leave to support working mothers and promoting workplace gender equality.

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar rightly remarked that the progress of a community can be measured by the degree of progress women have achieved. Therefore, a welfare state must adopt a holistic approach to eliminate systemic discrimination against women and ensure their empowerment.

Q7: Digital transformation alone cannot solve the deep-rooted problems in India's school education system.
Comment **(10 Marks, 150 Words)**

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about digitization of education.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting the benefits of digital transformation in education followed by digital transformation alone cannot address the deep-rooted problems in India's school education system.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: With the Internet penetration rate estimated to surpass 55% by the end of 2025 in India, digitization of education remains a top priority for the government. Initiatives like PM e-Vidya, SWAYAM Prabha TV, DIKSHA, VidyaDaan, and e-Pathshala reflect the accelerated shift towards digital education.

Benefits of Digital Transformation in Education

- **Access to Quality Education:** Online courses and e-learning platforms can bridge the gap between urban and rural education standards.
- **Personalized Learning:** Adaptive learning technologies can identify students' strengths and weaknesses, providing targeted support.
- **Inclusivity:** Digital tools can support students with disabilities through features like text-to-speech, speech-to-text, and customizable interfaces.
- **Cost-Effectiveness:** Digital textbooks and online resources can reduce the costs associated with physical textbooks, materials and infrastructure.

However, digital transformation alone cannot address the deep-rooted problems in India's school education system:

- **Poor Learning Outcomes:** The ASER 2022 report revealed an alarming decline in students' performance in mathematics, with only 20.1% of Class V and 38.1% of Class VIII students knowing division.
- **Accessibility Issues:** The number of schools decreased from 15.09 lakh in 2020-21 to 14.89 lakh in 2021-22, highlighting difficulties in accessing education, especially for marginalized communities.
- **High Dropout Ratio:** According to the NSO, one out of eight students enrolled in schools drops out midway, with over 62.9% of dropouts occurring in high school.
- **Higher Female Dropout Rate:** Nearly 21% of girls drop out due to the high cost of education, compared to 16% of boys.
- **Regional Variation:** While the all-India (rural) attendance rate for children is close to 72%, there are significant variations between states.
- **Affordability Issues:** Rural students' expenses on books, stationery, and uniforms are over 10 percentage points higher than those in urban areas.
- **Exclusion of Disadvantaged Groups:** Only around 27% of schools have special toilets for children with special needs. The literacy rate of Scheduled Tribes (STs) was only 59% compared to the overall literacy rate of 73%, according to Census 2011.

Additionally, there is inequality in access to digital resources due to limited internet penetration and low literacy levels.

To address these issues, measures must go beyond digitization:

- **Increased Funding:** Despite the 'highest ever' allocation in the Union Budget 2023-24, the education sector's share of GDP remains stagnant at 2.9%, much lower than the recommended 6%.
- **Focus on Learning:** Independent bodies and civil society organizations, along with the Ministries, need to constantly monitor learning outcomes.
- **Addressing Gender Bias:** Schools should create conducive environments for dialogue, discussion, and address gender biases. Easy and safe access to counseling and support must be provided for female students.
- **Equal Access to Digital Education:** Guaranteeing economic security with an assured basic income can help bridge the digital divide.

- **Urban Planning and Education:** Well-planned and designed schools can ensure equal access to education for all students, especially for divyangians. Singapore's model can serve as an example.

Thus, digitization must be complemented by addressing inequalities to ensure equitable access to high-quality education for all learners, regardless of their social or economic background.

Q8: How far do you support India aligning strongly with the Western bloc in the light of increasing Russian dependence on China?
(10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about India's policy of non-alignment (now Strategic Autonomy).

Body: Address the demand by highlighting increasing Russian Dependence on China then mention Benefits of India's alignment with the West followed by challenges associated with it.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: India has followed the policy of non-alignment (now Strategic Autonomy) which aims to avoid aligning with any military blocs and take decisions as per India's national interest. Since Cold War, India has maintained balance in its relations with USA as well as Russia.

In the light of ongoing border tensions with China and Russia & China going for No-Limits Partnership, experts have suggested India to strengthen its relations with the western bloc to better protect its interests.

Increasing Russian Dependence on China

- Bilateral trade has grown from \$140 billion in 2021 to over \$240 billion in 2023.
- Russia supports China's Belt and Road initiative.
- Defence cooperation: Russia has imported s-400 air defence system, Su-35 fighter jets etc.

Benefits of India's alignment with the West:

- Shared concerns about China's rise and resultant instability in the Indo-Pacific and beyond.
- Hedging against possible future tensions with China
- Greater cooperation and coordination on platforms like QUAD, I2U2, Indo-Pacific etc.
- Shared values of democracy, tolerance, diversity, Human Rights etc.
- Western nations are best suited to fulfil India's defence needs and vision of Make in India in the defence sector. E.g.- jet Engine Technology with France.

Challenges:

- It will go against the Indian policy of strategic autonomy.
- India might get dragged in West's conflicts across the globe.
- It may jeopardise India's relation with other nations like Russia, Iran, Syria etc.
- India's 60% of defence platforms are of Russian origin. It cannot be changed overnight.
- While Russia has been a reliable partner providing state of the art platforms like s-400, US defence platforms come with conditionalities.
- India's deep engagements with the West can further destabilise northern borders with China.

India has tried to balance its relation through membership of QUAD, I2U2, BRICS and SCO and recent state visit to Russia. Thus, India should continue to balance its relations with both blocs and maintain strategic autonomy while going for issue-based alliances and partnership.

Q9: What are the reasons behind ongoing Israel-Hamas conflict? Discuss the impact of the conflict on India's interests in West Asia.
(10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Israel- Hamas conflict.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting reason behind conflict followed by impact on India's interests in West

Asia.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: Israel- Hamas conflict began with Hamas attack on Israel on 07th October 2023 killing about 1200 people and taking 250 hostages. Israel's responded with massive attack that has killed over 30,00 people.

Reasons Behind Conflict:

- **Immediate Reason:** Hamas attack on Israel and Israel's counter-offensive aimed at ending Hamas.
- **Historical Factor:** Balfour Declaration and subsequent UN Partition Plan split Palestine between Jews and Palestinian Arabs. This was not accepted by Palestinian leaders leading to the 1948 Arab-Israeli War.
- **Israel's encroachment:** Israel has been continuously occupying land and building colonies in West Bank which has been declared illegal and the international community and resented by Palestinians.
- **Religious Divide:** The conflict between Islam and Judaism over the disputed site of Al-Aqsa Mosque, which was constructed on the place of Second Jewish Temple.
- **Israel's security concerns:** Israel is surrounded by hostile neighbours in the region. The Hamas attack was the largest killing of the Jews since the World War II. Thus, Israel responded with all force to end Hamas.
- **Global dimension:** Israel is backed by the USA while Hamas is backed by Iran, two arch-rivals.

Impact on India's interests in West Asia

- **Diplomatic Balancing:** India enjoys good relations with both Israel and Palestine. The conflict and resultant humanitarian crisis might complicate the diplomatic balancing.
- **Complicate West Asian Geopolitics:** India has tried to expand its stake in the region through I2U2 initiative. The conflict has deteriorated the Israel-Arab relations and thus complicated India's initiatives in the region.
- **Energy Security:** India's energy security is heavily reliant on oil imports from West Asia, including countries like Saudi Arabia, UAE, and Iran. Instability in the region can impact oil prices and supply chains.
- **Security cooperation:** Defence cooperation with Israel includes procurement of advanced military technology, joint exercises, and intelligence sharing. The ongoing conflict might lead to delay in procurement and delivery.
- **New Projects:** India is a member of India-Middle east- Europe Corridor with Haifa port in Israel as an important link. The conflict can result in delay in implementation of the project.
- **Impact on Diaspora:** The large Indian diaspora in West Asia, particularly in GCC countries, is vulnerable to regional instability. Any escalation in conflict could affect their safety and employment.

India has provided humanitarian support to Palestine and has made efforts to ensure ceasefire during the month of Ramzan. India should engage with other partners like USA to implement a cease fire and expedite the solution for lasting peace in the region.

Q10: While mentioning various formulas suggested for UNSC reform, discuss the bases of India's claim to the permanent membership of UNSC. (10 Marks, 150 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about digitization of education.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting various formula suggested for UNSC reforms followed by arguments in favor of India's membership.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: United Nations Security Council (UNSC) is the pre-eminent organ of the United Nations with the power of enforcement of UN decisions. There has been a call for reform of the UNSC to make it more democratic and representative.

Various Formula suggested for UNSC reforms:

2005 Annan plan: The then UN Secretary General Kofi Annan presented two alternatives to reform the UNSC expanding it to 24 members.

- **Plan A** calls for creating six new permanent members, plus three new nonpermanent members for a total of 24 seats in the council.
- **Plan B** calls for creating eight new seats in a new class of members, who would serve for four years, subject to renewal, plus one nonpermanent seat, also for a total of 24.

In July 2005, Five UN members, Italy, Argentina, Canada, Colombia and Pakistan presented a plan that maintains five permanent members and raises the number of non-permanent members to 20.

Arguments in favour of India's membership:

- **India has largest population** presenting 1/6th of humanity, largest democracy, 4th strongest military and 5th largest economy.
- **Commitment to UN Charter and rule of law:** India has shown strong commitment to the principles of UN charter, democracy, Human rights, pacifism, and Rule of Law.
- **Leader of the global south:** India is considered as the leader of the global south. Thus, India's presence in the UNSC will ensure that concerns of developing world is being taken care of.
- **Presently UNSC is divided between P3 and P2.** India with commitment to non-alignment and strategic autonomy can help in diluting the polarity.
- **Contribution to UNPKF:** India is among the biggest contributor to the United Nations Peace Keeping Force.
- **Responsible Nuclear Power:** India has proved its credential as a responsible nuclear power with strong commitment to non-proliferation and self-imposed moratorium.

However, the opposition from the coffee club members, who demand reform through consensus remain challenge to India's membership. China a permanent member, has been opposed to India's membership since it doesn't want India to have veto power.

In order to make the UN representative and the UNSC relevant to the changing global order, UNSC reform and making India a permanent member is sine-qua-non.

Q11: The relationship between the State and NGOs in India has shifted from partnership to regulation with the stringent norms of the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA). Examine (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about State and NGOs.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting evolution of STATE-NGO relationship followed by impact of FCRA regulation.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: The State and NGOs often functioned as partners, working collaboratively towards developmental and social goals. However, with the introduction and subsequent amendments to the FCRA, the State's role has increasingly shifted towards that of a regulator.

Evolution of State-NGO Relationship

- **Pre-FCRA Era: Partnership and Collaboration**
 - **Early Independence Period:** NGOs played a crucial role in supplementing government efforts in development, health, education, and social welfare. The State often relied on NGOs to reach marginalized and remote areas.
 - **Collaborative Efforts:** The government provides grants and support to NGOs to implement various schemes and projects.

- **Post-FCRA Era: Regulation and Control**

- **Introduction of FCRA (1976):** The FCRA was enacted to regulate the acceptance and utilization of foreign contributions to ensure that foreign contributions do not adversely affect the sovereignty and integrity of India.
- **Amendments and Stricter Regulations:** Particularly the FCRA 2020 amendment, have imposed stricter compliance requirements on NGOs. These include mandatory registration, stringent reporting standards, and increased scrutiny of financial transactions.

Impact of FCRA regulation:

- **Increased Regulatory Oversight**

- **Registration and Renewal:** NGOs must register with the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) to receive foreign contributions.
- **Banking and Utilization:** NGOs are required to route all foreign contributions through a designated FCRA bank account in New Delhi. This centralization aims to monitor and control the flow of foreign funds more effectively.
- **Administrative expenses:** Reducing the limit of usage of foreign contribution for administrative expenses from 50% to 20%.

- **Challenges for NGOs**

- **Financial Strain:** The cap on administrative expenses (20% of foreign contributions) limits the operational capacity of NGOs, affecting their ability to pay salaries and maintain infrastructure.
- **Cancellation of Licenses:** There have been numerous instances of FCRA licenses being canceled, resulting in the cessation of operations for many NGOs, especially those dependent on foreign funding.

- **Shift in Dynamics**

- The focus on monitoring and control overshadows the collaborative spirit of the earlier State-NGO relationship.
- While the government's intention to ensure accountability and prevent misuse of foreign funds is valid, the stringent regulations have posed significant challenges for NGOs.

The current regulatory framework necessitates a balance where the State can ensure transparency and accountability without stifling the operational efficacy and autonomy of NGOs.

Q12: Highlight the potential advantages and challenges of incorporating artificial intelligence (AI) into e-governance. Suggest measures to enhance the integration of AI in e-governance systems.

(15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Artificial Intelligence.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting advantages and challenges of incorporating artificial intelligence (AI) into e-governance followed by way forward.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: Artificial Intelligence is branches of computer science that enable the creation of intelligent systems that can learn from data and make predictions. Incorporating artificial intelligence (AI) into e-governance offers numerous potential advantages, enhancing efficiency, transparency, and responsiveness in government operations.

Advantages of incorporating artificial intelligence (AI) into e-governance:

- **Data Analysis:** AI can analyze vast amounts of government data to help in informed decision-making.
 - For Example, India's Aadhaar system utilizes AI to analyze demographic and biometric data, streamlining service delivery and improving accuracy.
- **Virtual Assistants:** AI-powered virtual assistants can handle citizen queries and provide personalized assistance.

- For Example, MyGov India's chatbot, e-Mitra, helps citizens access government services and information efficiently.
- **Decision Support Systems:** AI can assist policymakers in making evidence-based decisions.
 - The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission uses machine learning to develop clinical decision support systems for doctors, improving healthcare delivery and patient outcomes.
- **Resource Optimization:** AI can analyze data to optimize resource allocation in government programs and initiatives.
 - India's Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) system uses AI to identify and eliminate duplicate and ghost beneficiaries, ensuring that resources reach the intended recipients efficiently.
- **Citizen Sentiment Analysis:** AI can analyze social media and citizen feedback to gauge public sentiment.
 - India's Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) employs AI to monitor social media sentiments towards government policies, enabling more responsive and citizen-centric governance.

Potential challenges in incorporating artificial intelligence (AI) into e-governance:

- **Privacy Concerns:** The use of AI in e-governance involves processing large amounts of personal data, raising significant privacy concerns.
 - For example, the Aarogya Setu app in India faced criticism in 2020 for potential privacy violations while handling COVID-19 data.
- **Skill Gaps:** Integrating AI requires skilled personnel and continuous training, which can be a challenge in bureaucratic setups.
- **Accessibility Issues:** AI-based e-governance systems may exclude citizens with limited access to technology or digital literacy, posing accessibility challenges.
- **Ethical Concerns:** The use of AI in decision-making processes raises ethical questions, such as accountability, responsibility, and fairness.

Measures to Enhance Integration:

- **Capacity Building:** Invest in training government officials in AI technologies and data analytics to effectively manage and utilize AI-driven systems.
- **Combat Bias:** Mitigate bias in data collection, labeling, and algorithms. Use diverse and representative data sets to ensure fair outcomes for all citizens, and regularly audit AI systems for potential biases.
- **Prioritize Security and Privacy:** Implement robust data security measures to protect sensitive information.
- **Improve Accessibility:** Integrate AI tools that enhance accessibility, such as language translation, text-to-speech conversion, etc.
- **Develop Ethical Guidelines:** Establish clear ethical guidelines to address issues such as fairness, transparency, accountability, and the ethical use of AI in public services.

By implementing these measures, governments can enhance the integration of AI in e-governance systems, ensuring that AI technologies are used responsibly, effectively, and in a manner that benefits all citizens.

Q13: The Citizen Charter was enacted to ensure good governance by improving public services delivery, but it did not achieve the anticipated success. Analyse (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Citizen's Charter.

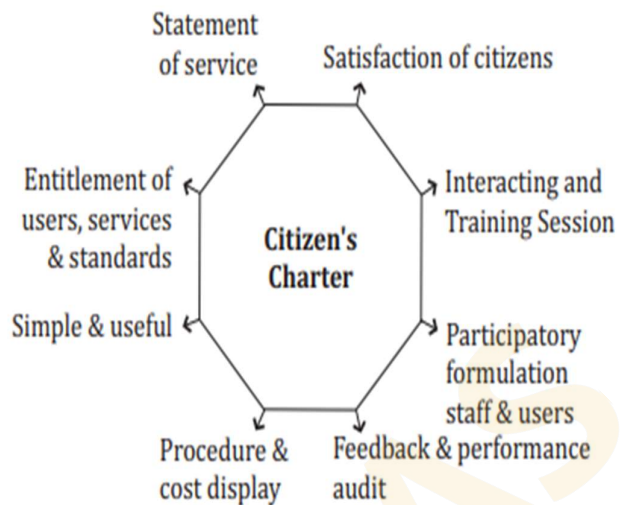
Body: Address the demand by highlighting how Citizen Charter enhances the quality of public services and what are the challenges faced by CC in ensuring good governance.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: Citizen's Charter is a written, voluntary declaration by service providers that highlights the standards of service delivery that they must subscribe to, availability of choice for consumers, avenues for grievance redressal and other related information.

Citizen Charter enhances the quality of public services through:

- **Service Standards:** Establishing clear service standards to ensure prompt and efficient service delivery.
 - For example, the Passport Seva Kendra's Citizen Charter outlines specific timeframes for passport issuance.
- **Empowering Citizens:** Encouraging citizen engagement in decision-making processes, like Kerala's Participatory Budgeting, where citizens collaborate with elected representatives to prioritize development initiatives.
- **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Promoting regular assessment of service delivery quality, as seen in initiatives like Bengaluru's Citizen Perception Survey.
- **Accountability and Transparency:** Emphasizing accountability through mechanisms like audits and public disclosure, supported by global initiatives like the Open Government Partnership.



Citizen Charter movement has faced challenges:

- **Implementation Issues:** Inconsistent implementation across different government departments has undermined the Charter's impact.
- **Lack of Awareness and Participation:** Many citizens, especially in rural areas, remain unaware of their rights under the Charter, limiting its effectiveness.
- **Corruption and Bureaucratic Delays:** Instances of bribery and bureaucratic inefficiencies continue to plague service delivery, undermining the Charter's objectives.
- **Ineffective Grievance Redressal:** Weak mechanisms for handling complaints have further eroded trust in the Charter's effectiveness.

Way Forward:

- **Awareness Campaigns:** Publicize charters widely through diverse media, ensuring accessibility for all, including persons with disabilities.
- **Decentralized Formulation:** Delegate charter formulation to local levels and also involve consumer groups and civil society organizations for better formulation.
- **Clear Service Standards:** Ensure goals with quantifiable metrics for easy understanding.
- **Redressal Mechanism:** Give time bound remedies for service failures and assign responsibility clearly.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Legally enforce charters and regularly update them with external evaluation.

The Citizen Charter initiative in India holds great potential to enhance public service delivery and promote good governance. By adopting a more holistic and integrated approach, the Citizen Charter can truly serve as a tool for ensuring accountability, transparency, and responsiveness in public services.

Q14: Discuss the reasons for the lack of nutritional security in India despite achieving agricultural surplus. Highlight the steps taken by the government to improve the situation. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about nutritional security along with relevant data.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting reasons for Lack of Nutritional Security in India followed by Steps taken by the government to improve nutritional security.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic with a way forward on a positive note.

Answer: Food security means having enough safe and nutritious food for everyone, which is evident from the production of an estimated 328.8 million tonnes of food grains in 2023-24. However, nutritional security focuses on a balanced and diverse diet with essential nutrients which is still lacking.

The recent NFHS 5 report highlights this issue, showing that 35.5% of children are stunted, and 57% of women and 25% of men are anaemic. The Global Hunger Index (2023) ranks India at 111 out of 125 countries.

Reasons for Lack of Nutritional Security in India

- **Cropping Patterns and Agricultural Practices:** The focus on cultivating rice and wheat often overshadows the production of nutrient-rich crops like millets and pulses, contributing to nutritional insecurity.
- **Poverty:** Many people in India live below the poverty line and cannot afford a nutritious diet. High poverty rates in states like Bihar and Odisha lead to inadequate nutrition.
- **Regional Disparities:** States like Punjab and Haryana have better access to nutritious food due to better facilities, while states like Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh face higher rates of malnutrition due to limited resources.
- **Inadequate Social Safety Nets:** The lack of robust social welfare programs and safety nets limits access to nutritious food for vulnerable populations, such as tribal communities in Madhya Pradesh and Jharkhand.
- **Unmonitored Nutrition Programmes:** For instance, several states have failed to effectively implement the Mid-Day Meal Scheme (MDMS).

Steps taken by the government to improve nutritional security:

- **National Food Security Act (NFSA):** Provides subsidized food grains through the Public Distribution System (PDS). For example, in Bihar, the NFSA has significantly reduced food insecurity.
- **Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS):** Offers supplementary nutrition, health check-ups, and immunization to children under six and pregnant and lactating women.
- **Poshan Abhiyan:** Launched in 2017, this mission aims to reduce malnutrition and stunting in children, anemia among women, and low birth weight through a multi-sectoral approach.
- **Fortification of Food:** Encourages the addition of essential nutrients to staple foods. For example, in Karnataka, the government has mandated the fortification of edible oils, wheat flour, and salt to improve nutritional status.
- **Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs):** For example, Akshaya Patra Foundation partners with the government in various states to provide nutritious mid-day meals to schoolchildren, addressing both hunger and malnutrition.

Approach to Address Nutritional Security

- **Popularize Locally Grown Millets:** Use strategies like those employed by corporations to make locally grown millets as popular as imported oats or quinoa in India.
- **Supplementary Nutrition Programs:** Improve Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) for children and pregnant women. Example: Rajasthan's Annapurna Milk Scheme.
- **Addressing Micronutrient Deficiencies:** Distribute iron and folic acid supplements in schools. Example: Weekly Iron and Folic Acid Supplementation (WIFS) program.
- **Improving Water and Sanitation:** Ensure clean water and sanitation to prevent malnutrition. Example: Swachh Bharat Abhiyan.

We need to invest in agriculture, improve infrastructure, run education and awareness campaigns, and effectively implement nutrition programs. These efforts will help fight malnutrition, improve food access, and ensure long-term nutritional security for all Indians.

Q15: Evaluate the effectiveness of the government's urban poverty alleviation programs in reducing poverty in urban areas. Give examples to support your answer. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Poverty.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting effectiveness of government's urban poverty alleviation programs followed by limitations of urban poverty alleviation programs.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: According to the World Bank, poverty is deprivation in well-being, including low income and the inability to acquire basic goods and services necessary for survival with dignity. This poverty can be categorized as urban or rural.

Effectiveness of Government's Urban Poverty Alleviation Programs

- **Reduction in Multidimensional Poverty:** The Global Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) 2022 reported a drop in urban poverty from 9.0% to 5.5%.
- **Affordable Housing:** Under PMAY-Urban, 0.61 crore houses have been provided to urban poor, as per the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).
- **Capacity Development:** Under DAY-NULM, over 6.42 lakh urban poor were placed in self or wage employment between 2014-2022.
- **National Urban Livelihoods Mission (NULM):** Focuses on skill development and self-employment. It benefitted over a 50 lakh urban poor through skill training and self-employment opportunities.
- **Smart Cities Mission:** Enhances infrastructure and quality of life. It improved urban infrastructure and services in 100 cities, benefiting millions.
- **Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban)** Aims to make cities clean and open defecation free. This improved sanitation for the urban poor.
- **Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT)** Focuses on water supply, sewerage, and urban transport in 500 cities, improving urban living standards.
- **Health and Nutrition** Urban Primary Health Centres (UPHCs) provide accessible healthcare, reducing health-related vulnerabilities among the urban poor.

Limitations of Urban Poverty Alleviation Programs

- **Problem of Identification:** Programs often struggle to identify and reach the most vulnerable sections of the urban poor population, particularly because of the continuous influx of migrants into cities.
- **Housing Poverty:** According to MoHUA, 18.78 million urban households lacked decent housing between 2017-2012.
- **Lack of Functional Portability:** Government schemes for the urban poor lack portability, particularly for migrant workers.
- **Rapid Urbanization and Migration:** Rapid urbanization and migration make it hard to meet the needs of all urban poor residents effectively.
- **Funding Constraints** Insufficient funding leads to incomplete projects and limited reach, affecting the overall impact of programs. For example: Many PMAY housing projects remain unfinished due to budget shortages.
- **Implementation Gaps** Inefficient implementation at the local level often results in delays and suboptimal outcomes.

The government's urban poverty alleviation programs have made notable strides in reducing poverty through affordable housing and skill development. Drawing from successful models like Kerala's Ayyankali Urban Employment Guarantee Scheme could further enhance efforts to uplift the urban poor.

Q16: Despite numerous social protection initiatives, achieving Universal Social Security in India remains an elusive goal. Discuss. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Poverty.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting government initiatives for social protection followed by challenges to achieving universal social security.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note or with a way forward.

Answer: Social security ensures access to healthcare and income security, particularly in cases of old age, unemployment, sickness, maternity, loss of a breadwinner, etc.

Government Initiatives for Social Protection

- **For Workers:**
 - The Code on Social Security, 2020, addresses employees' social security in both organized and unorganized sectors, including maternity benefits for women.
 - Other schemes include the Atal Pension Yojana, National Pension Scheme for Traders, e-SHRAM Portal, and Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maan-dhan.
- **For the Poor and Special Groups:**
 - The National Food Security Act, 2013, provides subsidized food grains to the rural and urban poor.
 - The Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Yojana consolidates the PDS, offers gas cylinders, and provides wages under MGNREGA.
 - The National Social Assistance Programme supports the elderly, widows, and disabled individuals among the poor.
- **For Women and Children:**
 - The Midday-Meal school program aims to improve the nutritional status of school-age children.
 - The Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) offer supplementary nutrition, immunization, and pre-school education, benefiting pregnant and lactating mothers as well.
- **For the Elderly:** The Integrated Programme for Older People aim to enhance the quality of life for the elderly, while the Annapurna Scheme focuses on their food security.
- **For Healthcare:** The Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (Ayushman Bharat) seeks to increase the number of insured individuals and improve health services for the poor and vulnerable.

Challenges to Achieving Universal Social Security

- **Fragmentation of Schemes:** Existing schemes are divided across various departments, causing issues in data collection and last-mile delivery.
- **Lack of a Rights-Based Approach:** The Code on Social Security, 2020, lacks legal binding entitlements, statutory timelines, and concrete procedures for framing social security schemes.
- **Financial Literacy and Saving Capability:** Many Indians lack financial knowledge and the ability to save prudently, putting a burden on the government exchequer if universalization is pursued.
- **Accountability Issues:** The lack of accountability in administration and low awareness affect coverage in the existing system.
- **Unsuitability for Self-Employed Individuals:** Contributory schemes are not well-suited for self-employed people due to the volatility of their earnings.
- **Other Issues:** Exclusion errors, lack of transferability/portability of benefits, gender inequality, and technological disabilities further complicate the provision of universal social security benefits.

It requires a multifaceted approach involving policy reforms, increased funding, better implementation, and enhanced coverage of vulnerable groups. With concerted efforts, it is possible to move closer to the goal of universal social security, ensuring a dignified life for all citizens.

Q17: Give an account of the institutional mechanisms available to ensure the accountability of civil servants in India. Also, discuss the challenges faced in upholding this accountability and suggest measures to strengthen it.
(15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about accountability.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting institutional mechanism to uphold accountability followed by challenges faced in upholding accountability.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note or with a way forward.

Answer: Accountability is the obligation of those in power to be responsible and answerable for their actions. In India, civil servants are accountable to both the political Executive and the public. This accountability ensures transparent, responsive, and honest policy implementation and service delivery.

Institutional Mechanisms:

- **Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG):** Conducts financial, compliance, and performance audits of government accounts.
- **Central Vigilance Commission (CVC):** Investigates corruption cases involving public servants under the Central Vigilance Commission Act, 2003.
- **Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI):** Probes offenses committed by civil servants under the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946.
- **Political Accountability:** Civil servants are accountable to Ministers, who are, in turn, accountable to the public.
- **Lokpal and Lokayukta:** Investigate allegations against public servants at Central and state levels under the Lokpal and Lokayukta Acts, 2013.
- **Citizen's Charter:** Provides timelines for service delivery, enhancing accountability to the public.
- **Social Audit:** Engages citizens in analyzing public fund expenditure to ensure executive accountability.
- **Legislative Mechanisms:**
 - **Commission of Inquiry Act, 1952:** Empowers governments to set up commissions to investigate matters with civil court powers.
 - **Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988:** Punishes offenses like bribery and misappropriation with 1-7 years of imprisonment.
 - **Right to Information Act, 2005:** Mandates public officials to maintain and disclose records and particulars.

Challenges:

- **Low Conviction Rate:** Only about 37% under the Prevention of Corruption Act, according to NCRB.
- **Public-Administrative Gap:** The elitist nature of civil services deters public scrutiny.
- **Permanence of Job:** Constitutional job security often results in minor punishments like transfers for misuse of power.
- **Scope of Personal Discretion:** Significant discretion in duties can lead to power misuse and fact fabrication.
- **Misuse of RTI Act:** Section 8 empowers officials to deny information on grounds of national importance, shielding them from scrutiny.

Measures to Address Challenges in Civil Servants' Accountability:

- **Streamline Investigation Processes:** Expedite legal and investigative procedures to improve efficiency and increase conviction rates.
- **Encourage Public Engagement:** Foster platforms for citizen feedback and involvement in governance to reduce the elitist barrier.
- **Revise Disciplinary Measures:** Reform Article 311 to allow more stringent disciplinary actions beyond transfers, such as demotion or dismissal.

- **Implement Performance Reviews:** Conduct regular performance reviews to ensure accountability and address inefficiencies.
- **Regulate Discretionary Powers:**
 - Implement oversight mechanisms to review and audit discretionary decisions for accountability.
- **Prevent Misuse of RTI Act:** Clearly define and limit exemptions under Section 8 of the RTI Act to prevent misuse.
- **Training and Sensitization:** Regularly train civil servants on ethical standards, accountability, and public service obligations.
- **Strengthen Whistleblower Protection:** Ensure robust protection and support for whistleblowers to encourage reporting of corruption and misconduct.
- **Leverage Technology:** Use technology and digital tools to enhance transparency, track accountability, and facilitate public access to information.

To enhance accountability and governance, strengthening institutional mechanisms, amending Article 311 for disciplinary actions, implementing performance budgeting, and enforcing Citizens' Charters are essential measures.

Q18: India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) can be a game-changer for India, West Asia as well as global economy. Comment. Highlight the key challenges to the projects. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting reasons why it's a game changer for India and the West Asia along with global economy.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor is a planned economic corridor that aims to foster connectivity and economic integration between Asia, the Persian Gulf and Europe. It passes from India to Europe through the United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia, Israel and Greece.

Gamechanger for India

- Enhanced economic ties with Middle Eastern countries can bolster India's strategic partnerships in the region, countering the influence of rival powers.
- A seamless trade route connecting India to Europe via the Middle East can reduce transit time, lower transportation costs, and enhance trade efficiency.
- Development of ports, railways, and logistics hubs along the corridor will improve India's infrastructure, making it more competitive in global trade.
- Collaboration on renewable energy projects with Middle Eastern countries can help India diversify its energy mix and achieve its sustainable development goals.

Gamechanger for West Asia

- With both Saudi Arabia and Israel as its members, It can foster cooperation between both rivals in West Asia, ushering a new stable regional order.
- By providing a direct and efficient trade route between India, the Middle East, and Europe, IMEC can facilitate better market access and increased trade volumes, benefiting the economies of West Asian countries.
- West Asia's strategic location as a bridge between Asia and Europe can be leveraged to enhance its geopolitical influence in global trade and economic affairs.
- IMEC can stimulate PPPs in infrastructure projects, leveraging private sector expertise and funding for regional development.

Gamechanger for global economy

- IMEC aims to create a more direct trade route between India, the Middle East, and Europe, significantly reducing transit times compared to traditional sea routes through the Suez Canal.

- The corridor will streamline supply chains, reduce transportation costs, and enhance the efficiency of logistics networks.
- The corridor can serve as a counterbalance to China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), offering an alternative trade and infrastructure network.
- IMEC will provide diversified trade routes, reducing dependency on any single corridor and mitigating risks associated with geopolitical tensions or disruptions. E.g.- Houthis targeting ship[s] passing through Red sea.
- IMEC can incorporate sustainable transport solutions, such as electrified railways and energy-efficient logistics networks, reducing the environmental impact of trade and transportation.

Challenges to the Project

- The ongoing Israel-Hamas conflict has emerged as biggest threat to the corridor since the conflict zone is closer to the Haifa port.
- The conflict has increased tensions between Israel and Saudi Arabia, two key members of the corridor.
- Successful implementation of IMEC will require strong political will and coordination among participating countries to negotiate and finalize bilateral and multilateral agreements.

IMEC corridor can provide multiple benefits not just to the member countries but to the broader West Asia and global economy as well. The need is for member nations to engage to finish the modalities in a to me bound manner which can usher an era of stability and prosperity for the broader region and global economy.

Q19: In light of increasing Chinese overtures in the Indian Ocean, discuss the initiatives taken by India to project itself as the net security provider in the Indian Ocean region. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about emergence of Indian Ocean as an area of contestation.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting how Chinese overtures in the Indian Ocean followed by Steps taken by India to counter Chinese aggression.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note.

Answer: Net Security Provider is the nation which can address the security concerns of not only itself but also other countries in the vicinity or beyond. Indian Maritime security Strategy 2015 envisages India's role as a Net security Provider in the Indian Ocean region.

Indian Ocean has emerged as an area of contestation for dominance between India and China with frequent Chinese ship visits and India's rapid naval expansion and infrastructure upgradation.

Chinese overtures in the Indian Ocean

- Strategic maritime presence in the form of commercial and military facilities along key maritime routes in the Indian Ocean, including ports in Pakistan (Gwadar), Sri Lanka (Hambantota), Myanmar (Kyaukpyu), and Djibouti.
- **Anti-Piracy Operations:** Chinese naval deployments in the Indian Ocean have often been justified under the guise of anti-piracy operations, contributing to their continuous presence in the region.
- China has been strengthening its bilateral relations with Indian Ocean littoral states like Pakistan, Iran, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh and Maldives through economic assistance, military cooperation, and diplomatic engagement.
- Chinese spy vessels and Yuan Wang 03 and xiang Yang Hong 01 have been frequently visiting Indian Ocean region.

Steps taken by India

- **Fleet Expansion:** India has invested in aircraft carriers, such as INS Vikramaditya and the indigenous INS Vikrant for power projection, Strengthened the submarine fleet like INS Arihant to enhance underwater capabilities and has inducted modern destroyers, frigates, and corvettes, such as the Kolkata-class destroyers and Kamorta-class corvettes to improves surface warfare capabilities.

- **Logistics Exchange Agreements:** Agreements like the Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement (LEMOA) with the US and similar pacts with Australia, Japan, and France facilitate operational support and logistics sharing.
- **Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region (IFC-IOR)** based in Gurgaon, facilitates real-time information sharing on maritime security issues among IOR countries. It enhances collaboration on maritime domain awareness, piracy prevention, and disaster response.
- **Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS)** provides a platform for naval dialogue and cooperation among IOR navies, fostering mutual understanding and collaborative security efforts.
- **Escort Missions:** Deploying naval assets for escort missions to protect merchant vessels from piracy, particularly off the coast of Somalia and the Gulf of Aden.
- **Disaster Response:** Rapid deployment of naval assets for disaster relief operations, such as during the 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami, Cyclone Idai in Mozambique, and the earthquake in Nepal.
- **Evacuation Operations:** Conducting evacuation operations, such as Operation Rahat in Yemen, to rescue stranded Indian and foreign nationals.

With the recent efforts like saving ships from Somali pirates and rescuing against Houthi attacks, India has underscored its role as the net security provider in the Indian Ocean region.

Q20: Assess the role of emerging powers, including India, in shaping the future of global governance and international security. (15 Marks, 250 Words)

Approach to the answer:

Introduction: Start with introducing in brief about Global order in present context.

Body: Address the demand by highlighting Role of emerging power including of India then mention how it's shaping the international security followed by challenges.

Conclusion: Conclude with summarizing the topic on a positive note or with a way forward.

Answer: Global order is in a state of flux. US-led unipolarity is being challenged by revisionist China. But attempts towards a bipolar world is being countered by emerging powers like India, Japan, Germany, Brazil, Australia etc. who prefer a multipolar global order.

Role of emerging powers:

In shaping future of global governance:

- Democratizing institutions of global governance like IMF and World Bank and making them more representative.
- Creating parallel and competing institutions like New Development Bank and Contingency Reserve Arrangements.
- Alternative funding mechanisms like Asia Africa Growth Corridor (AAGC) to help developing nations and LDCs in infrastructure development and protect them from debt trap diplomacy.
- Protecting the interest of global south at platforms like WTO and ensuring an equitable global trade order and economic cooperation in the face of US-China trade wars.
- Ensuring access to technology and funding to the global south so that they can tackle the impact of Climate Change. E.g.- OSOWOG, International Solar Alliance etc.

Role of India:

- Since India has been a voice of Global South at multiple forums, India's role become all the more significant.
- India is a member of platforms like BRICS and SCO, which are seen as alternative to west dominated global order.
- India is the host of G20. Thus, it has the responsibility to drive the global discussion away from geopolitics and towards challenges like economic recession, climate change food security etc.

Shaping the International security:

- Since emerging powers are swing states in US-China bipolarity, they have potential to prevent escalation of hostilities and deterioration of security environment.
- On the lines of NAM during the cold war era, emerging powers can dilute bipolarity and thus emergence of a new cold war.
- By taking principled stand against violation of sovereignty and respect for UN-led order, these nations can prevent adventurism by US and China.
- They can direct the discussion away from hard options like military security and towards Human security on topics like terrorism, xenophobia etc.

Role of India:

- India enjoys cordial relations with both Eastern and western blocs. So, India can act as an impartial mediator and negotiator in situations like Ukraine crisis.
- Since Indo-Pacific is becoming the new region of geopolitical contestation and has hotspots like Taiwan Korean Peninsula, proactive role of India in security domain can help in stabilizing the region and thus whole globe.
- In the wake of rising China, ASEAN looks at India as a preferred security partner due to tradition of pacifism and respect for rule and law.

Challenges

- Initiatives like AAGC and OSOWOG have not taken off.
- Emerging powers like Japan and Australia have greater dependence on USA and are hesitant to take autonomous decisions.
- With increasing polarization between East and West, developing nations are going for hedging strategy.
- Emerging powers lack the economic and military might to provide alternative to the options provided by USA or China

India's economic boom in the face of sluggish global economy, leadership of global south and presidency of G20 is the right time to transcend from rule-follower to rule-maker at the global high table. With its tradition of pacifism, rule of law and Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam, India along with other emerging powers, can guide the world. for a peaceful and better tomorrow.